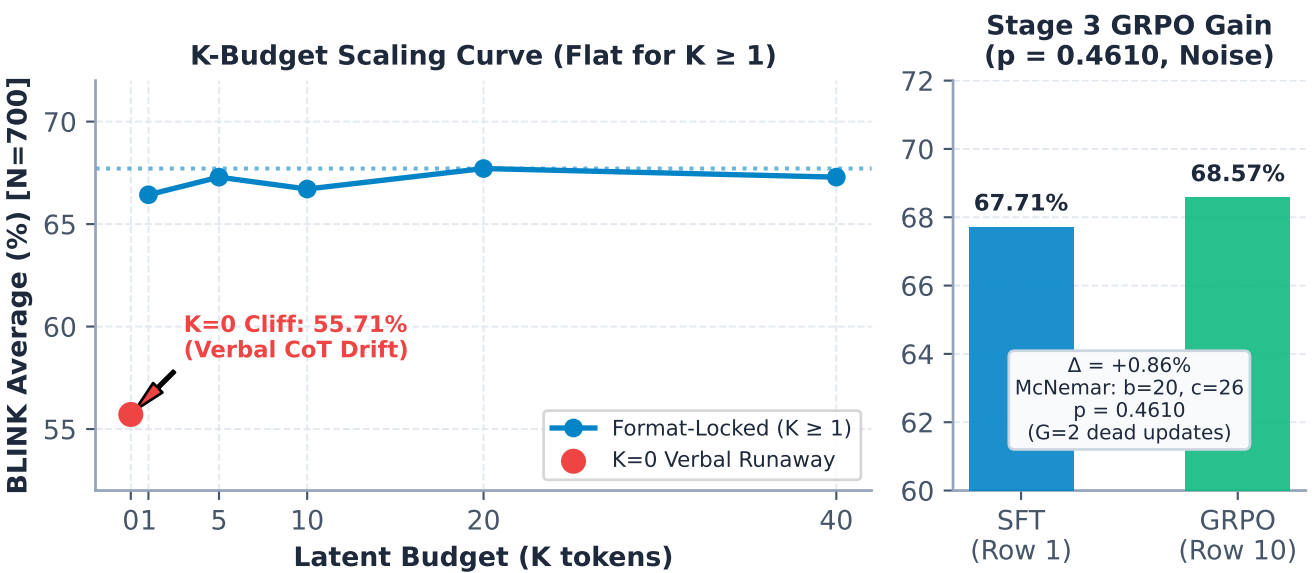
K-Budget Scaling Curve (Flat for K ≥ 1)
BLINK Average (%) [N=700]
70
65
60
55
K=0 Cliff: 55.71%
(Verbal CoT Drift)
Format-Locked (K ≥ 1)
K=0 Verbal Runaway
01
5
10
20
40
Latent Budget (K tokens)
Stage 3 GRPO Gain
(p = 0.4610, Noise)
72
70
68
66
64
62
60
67.71%
68.57%
Δ = +0.86%
McNemar: b=20, c=26
p = 0.4610
(G=2 dead updates)
SFT
(Row 1)
GRPO
(Row 10)